



FAQ: Student Builder Group Leader Storytelling for Career Readiness

**Train the Trainer FAQs for Group
Leaders**

General overview

Question 1: What is the Storytelling for Career Readiness Workshop?

It's a 2-hour instructor-led training (ILT) session designed to help Cloud Club members learn how to communicate their technical experiences clearly and confidently for interviews, networking, and beyond. As a Group Leader, your role is to facilitate the experience, not to be an expert storyteller yourself.

Question 2: What is the Train the Trainer session for?

The Train the Trainer is about a 20-minute session that prepares you to deliver the full 2-hour workshop. It walks you through the program structure, how to use each asset, and how to facilitate effectively. It is *not* a replay of the learner workshop—it's your facilitator map.

Question 3: Do I need to be an expert storyteller to run this workshop?

No. Your role is to create a safe, focused space where learners can practice and hear themselves clearly. If you protect practice time and keep the energy high, the workshop design will do the rest.

Workshop structure and flow

Question 1: What is the agenda for the 2-hour workshop?

The workshop follows this flow:

- **Warm-up** – Cloud in a post activity
- **Storytelling frameworks** – Introduction to the STAR method
- **Group story-building** – Pairs practice building stories from scenarios
- **Interview role-plays** – Rotating interviewer, candidate, and observer roles
- **Personal story and brief introduction** – 30-second elevator pitch practice
- **Wrap-up** – Key takeaways and next steps

Question 2: How should I manage the pacing?

The design intentionally alternates between short concept introductions and hands-on practice. Your job is to keep that rhythm moving. If you're running short on time, shorten discussions, but never cut practice time.

Activities and facilitation

Question 1: What is the cloud in a post warm-up activity?

Learners write one sentence explaining something they learned in the course as if posting on social media for someone who knows nothing about the cloud or technology. Give them about 3 minutes. You can have them start right away or provide example posts first to set expectations.

Question 2: What is the STAR framework, and how do I introduce it?

STAR stands for *Situation, Task, Action, Result*. Introduce it as a scaffold, not a script. The goal is for learners to map their experiences with clarity, not to produce polished, perfect answers. Walk through an example behavioral question, such as “Tell me about a time when...” and explain how to use STAR to answer it effectively.

Question 3: How should I handle the Cutting the Jargon section?

This section often feels uncomfortable for learners, and that's okay. Your job isn't to correct them—it's to help them translate. Use guiding questions, such as “How would you explain that to someone outside your program?” Highlight the contrast between a jargon-heavy explanation and a clear business story, and explain why the plain-language version works better.

Question 4: How do the interview role-plays work?

Learners are placed in groups of three and rotate through three roles: *interviewer*, *candidate*, and *observer*. Everyone plays each role. The goal is to practice clarity under pressure. Encourage interviewers to ask follow-up questions instead of accepting the first answer. This prevents learners from relying on one memorized response.

Question 5: What should the observer do during the role-plays?

The observer uses a checklist to evaluate the interaction as follows:

- What was clear?
- What was confusing?
- Where did jargon appear?
- Did the story follow STAR?

This structured observation helps reinforce the learning for all participants.

Question 6: What is the 30-second brief introduction activity?

Learners craft and practice a short personal introduction that covers who they are, what they've done, what they want, and a call to action. Pairs exchange introductions and give feedback. The goal is for the introduction to sound authentic and natural, not rehearsed.

Question 7: How should I choose scenarios for the story-building activity?

Scenarios are available across four topic areas: smart campus, healthcare, agriculture, and logistics. Learners can choose the scenarios themselves, or you can assign scenarios to them. It's recommended to push learners toward more challenging scenarios. That's where the real learning happens.

Supporting materials

Question 1: Which materials are included in the facilitator package?

The package includes the following materials:

- **Facilitator Guide** – Detailed notes about the content and activities
- **Participant Guide** – Workbook for learners to use during and after the session
- **Mock Interview Kit** – Practice tool for interview simulations
- **Scenario Pack** – Story-building scenarios across topic areas
- **eLearning modules** – Three modules of 8–10 minutes each
- **12-Day Challenge** – Post-workshop daily storytelling prompts

Question 2: What are the three eLearning modules?

The three eLearning modules are as follows:

- **Building Your Personal Cloud and IoT Career Story** – Helps learners create a concise, adaptable career story for different interview contexts
- **Adapting to Different Interview Types** – Teaches learners to recognize interview styles and adjust their storytelling accordingly
- **Cutting the Jargon** – Helps learners recognize when technical language helps or hurts the conversation, and gives them a chance to practice translating jargon into plain language

These are extras that you can strongly recommend to learners for self-study outside of class.

Question 3: What is the 12-Day Challenge?

After the workshop, learners are encouraged to complete one short storytelling challenge each day for 12 days. Each challenge takes about 1–3 minutes. For example, on Day 1, learners are asked to record a 1-minute explanation of something they learned as if speaking to someone with no technical background. Learners can complete the challenges solo or with a peer buddy.

Facilitation best practices

Question 1: What are the key considerations for facilitating this workshop?

When facilitating this workshop, consider the following:

- **Set relevance early** – Anchor storytelling to interviews, networking, and confidence, not theory.
- **Protect practice time** – Practice time is the most valuable part of the workshop.
- **Model clarity, not perfection** – Use basic, human language.
- **Use guiding questions** – Ask "How would that land with a hiring manager?" instead of correcting directly.
- **Normalize discomfort** – Remind learners that awkwardness is part of the learning process.
- **Manage airtime intentionally** – Invite quieter voices to speak up, and gently limit dominant voices.
- **Reinforce progress** – Highlight improvement and effort, not polished final answers.

Question 2: What should I avoid as a facilitator?

As a facilitator, you should avoid the following:

- **Don't lecture the slides** – Learners can read the slides themselves. Your value is in facilitation, not narration.
- **Don't overexplain frameworks** – STAR is a tool, not something to memorize perfectly.
- **Don't rewrite learner stories** – Coach learners. Ownership of their personal story matters.
- **Don't shame jargon** – Translate together without calling jargon out as wrong.

- **Don't rush debriefs or have them run long** – Keep reflections focused and time bound.
 - **Don't aim for polish** – The workshop is about building confidence and clarity, not producing final interview answers.
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After the workshop

Question 1: What should I do to support learners after the session ends?

Assign each learner a peer buddy (also called a practice partner) so they have someone to continue practicing with. Encourage them to complete the 12-Day Challenge. Point them to the eLearning modules for continued skill building.

Question 2: What if I have questions that aren't covered in the materials?

Reach out to the point of contact identified by the program team. They will make sure you get the answers you need.